

<s:WindowedApplication> as the application root element. A beginning desktop application's code looks like this:

```

• <?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
• <s:WindowedApplication xmlns:fx="http://ns.adobe.com/
  mx/2009"
• xmlns:s="library://ns.adobe.com/flex/spark"
• xmlns:mx="library://ns.adobe.com/flex/mx">
• <fx:Declarations>
• <!-- Place non-visual elements (e.g., services, value
  objects) here -->
• </fx:Declarations>
• </s:WindowedApplication>

```

The WindowedApplication component is extended from Application and provides all the application-level functionality you expect from a typical Flex application. It also adds these capabilities that are unique to Flex desktop applications:

- Native menus can be displayed and integrated into the overall application look and feel.
- The application can be integrated with a dock or system tray icon to provide easy access to common application functions.
- The application can display operating system-specific “chrome” (the graphics in the application window’s border, title bar, and control icons).
- A status bar can be displayed at the bottom of the application window for string-based status messages.

Here’s an example. The WindowedApplication component can display a status bar at the bottom of the application window. This display is controlled by two of the WindowedApplication component’s properties, showStatusBar:Boolean, which is the property when true (by default), the application window displays a status bar and the status:String value displayed in the status bar. The following modified custom updateHTML() function from the NewTitlesReader application updates the application’s status bar with the title of the currently selected RSS item:

```

• private function updateHTML():void
• {
•   myHTML.location = feedSelector.selectedItem.link;
•   status = "Current Title: " + feedSelector.selectedItem.
  title;
• }

```